Music Unit Plan

Class: Form 4, Term 3

Unit: Harmony: Chord Qualities and Triads Through Aural Learning and Technology Integration

Goals: This unit should help students to:

Identify the qualities of triads (major, minor, diminished and augmented) by listening and from notation.

Construct triads on any root using interval structures.

Use the circle of fifths and key signatures to work out chords in major keys.

Describe the mood and function of different chords and progressions.

Harmonise a simple melody using primary chords (I, IV and V).

Perform chords and progressions on the keyboard individually and collaboratively.

Develop technological competence through digital tools (Coggle and Kahoot).

Foster confidence, collaboration and appreciation for harmony.

Skills, Knowledge, Attitudes and Values

Skills:

Aural identification of chords

Constructing triads

Keyboard chord playing

Notation

Harmonisation

Critical listening

Digital tools

Knowledge:

Triads: root, third, fifth

Interval qualities in triads

Four chord qualities

Triads in major keys

Primary chords I, IV, V

Chord symbols

Attitudes and Values:

Collaboration

Confidence

Appreciation

Perseverance

Respect

Rationale:

Harmony helps students understand why music sounds the way it does, and it underpins CSEC work in analysis, composition and performance. Form 4 students have already studied intervals and their qualities (major, minor, perfect, augmented and diminished) and the circle of fifths. However, chords can still seem like shapes to memorise rather than something students can work out for themselves. This unit links what students already know about intervals to the structure of chords, so that they can build, identify and use chords with understanding.

This unit adopts an aural-first, scaffolded approach in which students hear the difference between chord qualities, work out how each is built from intervals, and then apply this in notation, keyboard performance and the harmonisation of a melody. Technology supports understanding and feedback: Coggle is used for collaborative concept mapping, which makes the structure of chords visible, and Kahoot gives quick digital assessment. Optional use of Audacity allows students to record and compare chords.

The unit aligns with the CSEC Music syllabus (theory, performance and composition) by promoting:

- Musical literacy
- Performance
- Aural perception
- Technological competence
- Problem-solving
- Collaboration

Concepts to be taught (Graphic organiser)


Aural Skills
•Listening
•Identification
Progressions
Intervals
Harmony
Circle of Fifths
Triads
•Root
•Third
•Fifth
•Stacked thirds
Chord Quality
•Major / Minor
•Diminished / Augmented

Unit Content

The table below contains the following information:

- Lesson number in unit plan
- Lesson content
- Key Concepts to be taught in the lesson
- Learning outcomes
- Values and attitudes
- Resources needed for each lesson
- Teaching and learning activities
- Assessment strategies

Lesson #	Content	Key concept in the lesson	Learning Outcomes: Students will be able to	Values and Attitudes	Resources	Teaching/Learning Activities	Assessment strategies
1	Chord Qualities: Major, Minor, Diminished	Triad (root, third, fifth) Stacked thirds	Define a triad and state the intervals above the root for each	• Collaboration • Confidence	Keyboard Coggle Kahoot	Aural hook: same root, four sounds	Observation Coggle map check

	and Augmented Triads	Chord quality	of the four qualities. Construct and name major, minor, diminished and augmented triads on C, G and F. Explain how changing the third or fifth changes the quality. Play and identify the four qualities by ear.		Mini whiteboards Student devices	Teacher modelling of interval structures Collaborative Coggle concept map “Name that chord” and keyboard practice Kahoot quiz	Kahoot quiz (5 marks)
2	Triads in Major Keys	• Diatonic triads • Roman numerals	Construct triads on each degree	• Perseverance • Collaboration	Keyboard Manuscript paper	Review of Lesson 1	Worksheet Observation

		• Key signatures	of a major scale. State the quality of each (I, ii, iii, IV, V, vi, vii°). Use key signatures and the circle of fifths to find the notes.		Coggle map (extended) Chord chart	Building scale-degree triads in C and G major Extending the Coggle map Aural identification	Whiteboard check
3	Primary Chords I, IV and V	• Primary chords • Chord symbols • Keys on the circle of fifths	Identify and construct I, IV and V in C, G, F and D major. Play I–IV–V–I on the keyboard.	• Confidence • Appreciation	Keyboard Manuscript paper Speakers	Listening to chord examples Guided practice at the keyboard Pair work in several keys	Performance observation Short written check

			Describe the role of each chord.					
4	Chord Progressions and Cadences	• Progressions • Perfect, plagal, and imperfect cadences	Identify cadences by ear and in notation. Describe how cadences end musical phrases. Write a short progression ending with a cadence.	• Appreciation • Respect	Keyboard Speakers Devices Worksheet	Listening and discussion Cadence identification activities Writing and playing progressions	Worksheet Observation
5	Harmonising a Melody	• Choosing chords • Primary chords • Chord symbols	Select I, IV and V to fit a given melody. Write chord symbols	• Collaboration • Creativity	Short melodies Keyboard Manuscript paper	Teacher modelling Pair harmonisation Playback and discussion	Harmonisation task Peer feedback

			above the melody. Play the melody with chords.				
6	Triads in Minor Keys	• Relative minor • Harmonic minor • i, iv, and V	Construct triads in a minor key. State the quality of i, iv and V. Compare major and minor key chords.	• Perseverance • Confidence	Keyboard Coggle map (extended) Manuscript paper	Guided discovery using the circle of fifths Keyboard practice Aural comparison	Observation Worksheet
7	Aural Identification and Revision	• Chord quality • Progressions • Cadences	Identify chord qualities, progressions and cadences by ear.	• Perseverance • Collaboration	Keyboard Speakers Kahoot Audacity (optional)	Aural tests Revision stations Optional: record and compare chords in Audacity	Aural test Kahoot revision game

			Revise the construction of triads.					
8	Unit Assessment	• Evaluation • Harmonisation	Complete a written test on triads, chord qualities and progressions. Harmonise and perform a short melody.	• Pride • Responsibility	Test paper Keyboard Rubric	Written test Practical performance Reflection	Written test Practical rubric Reflection